

Structure: NOUN CLAUSES AND FUNCTIONS

A noun clause performs the same grammatical functions as nouns and noun phrase. These functions are:

1. Subject of the verb: examples
 - a. How Sola passed the examination beats the imagination of her teachers.
Function: Subject of the verb “beats”
 - b. Why he has refused to put in his letter of resignation is best known to him
Function: Subject of the verb is “known”
2. Subject Complement: example
 - a. The good news is that he passed his ICAN examination.
The underlined noun clause refers to the “good news”. A is the same thing as “the good news”
3. Object of verb: Examples
 - a. The authority awarded what is termed punctuality award.
Function: Object of the verb “awarded”
 - b. The suspect eventually accepted that he was guilty.
Function: Object of the verb “accepted”
 - c. The human rights activist explained why he was arrested by the police.
Function: Object of the verb “explained”
4. Object complement: Examples
 - a. The authority gave the student what is termed award for excellence.
Function: Complement of the object “student”
 - b. The robber killed the man because he did not give them what they demanded for.
Function: Complement of the object “them”
 - c. We narrated to our colleagues how we survived the ordeal.
Function: “Our colleagues” is the object of the verb narrated and the underlined noun clause complements the object our colleagues.
5. Complement of Preposition. Examples
 - a. His action resulted into what his father predicted
Function: Object of the preposition “into”
 - b. The money was restricted from the man who stole it.
Function: Object of the preposition “from”
6. In Apposition to a noun: A noun clause is in opposition to a noun when the noun clause and the noun refer to the same thing. Example
The news, that I was missing, spread across the village.
The noun clause “that I was missing” is in apposition to the noun “news”

Assignment

Identify the grammatical name and functions of the capitalized words.

1] I believe THAT HE IS INNOCENT

2] WHAT SHE SAID made me happy

3] the truth is THAT HE LIED

4] we are interested in WHAT YOU ARE DOING.

5] she is worried about WHAT HE DID.

Reference

Essential English Language for Senior Secondary Schools by Latilo T. A, et al.